Building the Top 100 Q&A

Building AI Applications
for Data Scientists and Software Engineers

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github.com/roadfoodr/top-100-qa-preso

Overview

Goal: produce the *Top 100 Q&A: AI Engineering*

Two broad phases:

- **Question generation** — 1,300 Discord threads distilled into 100 canonical questions
- **Answer generation** — manual top 10, then LLM-assisted top 100, then human review

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Extracting & Classifying Questions

Input: Discord logs from **four cohorts** (~1,300 threads)

Extracted first post from each thread (building on work by Pastor Soto)

Filtered out instructor and BiR posts

LLM classified each post: genuine question? Content / Logistics / Other?

Result: ~750 content questions

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Consolidating into Canonical Questions

Many questions repeated across cohorts — needed to consolidate

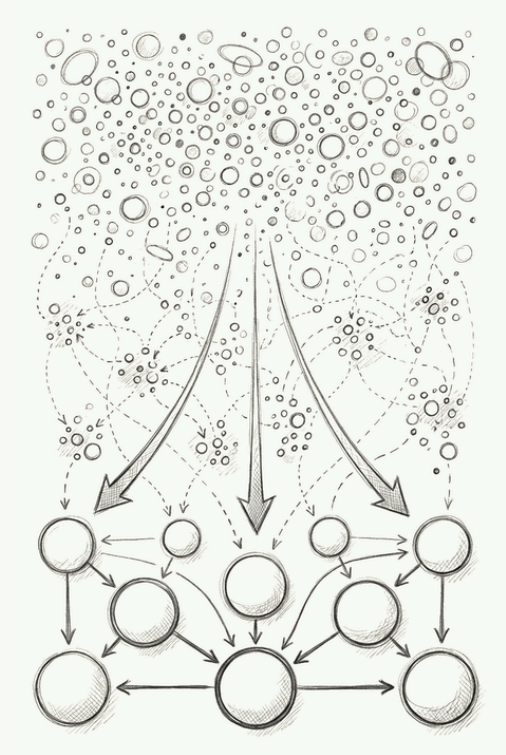
Key decision: granularity/specificity

- Too broad: different questions merged
- Too narrow: similar questions left separate
- e.g., "What vector DB?" and "How to configure ChromaDB?" — superficially similar topic, different intent, so don't merge

Grouped by intent first, topic second

Three parallel approaches, then merged into final list

Result: ~100 canonical questions, ranked by popularity



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Manual Top 10

Top 20 most popular reviewed by Hugo and BiRs

Top 10 selected — Hugo hand-wrote answers with BiR feedback

Published as blog post and shared with the class

Served as the style reference for all automated answers that followed

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Automated Top 100

Answers generated by Claude Code via custom skill

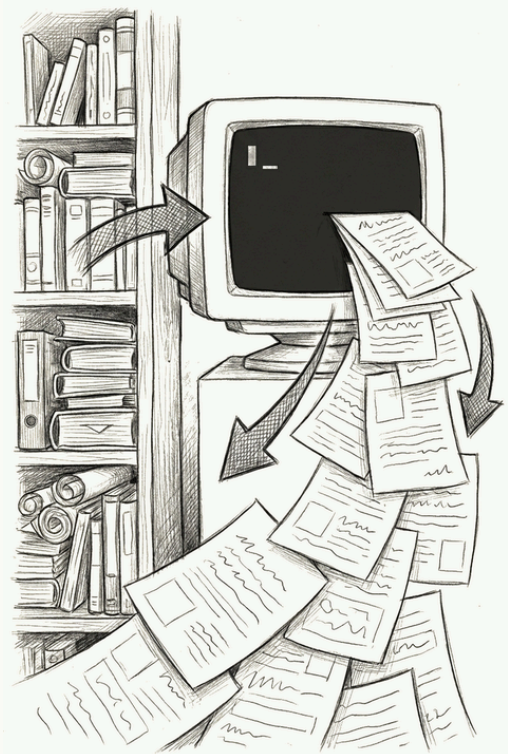
Style guide extracted from the top-ten document:

- 150-250 words per answer
- Lead with an **opinionated thesis**, follow with practical advice
- **Conversational-expert** tone — no academic or marketing language

Curated knowledge base for the skill to search:

- Discord transcripts, course reader chapters
- Earlier automated answers, workshop summaries & transcripts
- Top-ten Q&A document

Skill workflow: read questions → search sources → draft answers → write output



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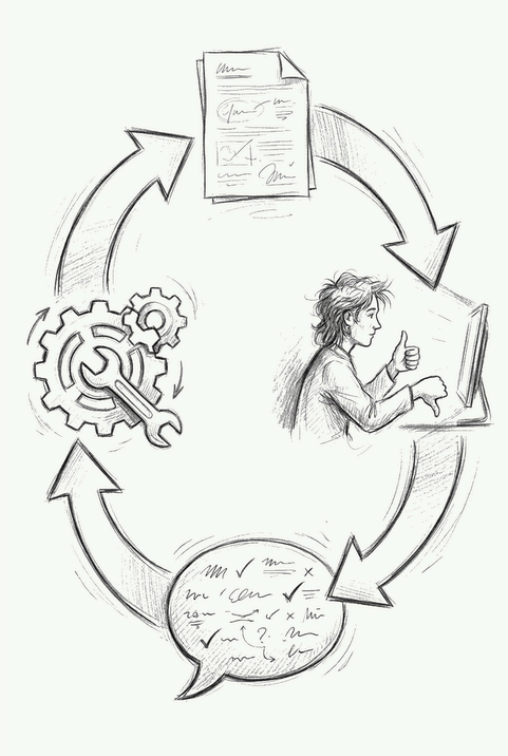
Annotation & Iteration

Custom annotation UI hosted on Modal (Turso database backend)

Each Q&A pair shown with **pass/fail controls** and comment field

Separate Claude Code skill for revision based on annotator feedback

Four rounds of generate → annotate → revise to reach final form